

Word family: **series / serial / serialize / serialise / serialization / serialisation**

Base word: series

Plural: series

Part of speech: mainly **noun**

Related forms:

series (n.) — 一系列；連串；系列；系列節目 / 作品

serial (adj.) — 連續的；系列的；序列的

serial (n.) — 連載作品；系列節目

serialize / serialise (v.) — 連載；使按序列排列

serialization / serialisation (n.) — 連載；序列化

Useful expressions / extensions:

a series of events

a series of questions

a series of stories

TV series

book series

lecture series

concert series

test series

series of numbers

series circuit

World Series

in series

serial number

serial killer

serial offender

serialized novel

Meaning in this passage

> Instead, he made it feel like a **series of human stories**.

Here, **series** means:

a number of related things that come one after another — 一連串；一系列

Mr Chan presented history not as isolated facts, but as many connected human stories unfolding over time.

****中文翻譯： ****

相反地，他把歷史講得像****一連串關於人的故事****。

So here:

****a series of stories = 一系列 / 一連串彼此相關或相繼出現的故事****

1. ****a series of things — 一系列；一連串****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> He made history feel like a ****series of human stories****.

他把歷史講得像****一連串關於人的故事****。

Practice 2

> The accident was caused by a ****series of mistakes****.

這宗意外是由****一連串錯誤****造成的。

Practice 3

> She asked me a ****series of questions****.

她問了我****一連串問題****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a series of X = 多個彼此相關、按次序或接連出現的 X****

2. ****a series of events — 一連串事件****

Practice 1

> A ****series of events**** led to the decision.

****一連串事件****最終導致了這個決定。

Practice 2

> The crisis began with a **series of small events**.

這場危機由**一連串小事件**開始。

MCQ-ready definition:

a series of events = 多件相繼發生、通常彼此有關聯的事件

3. **a series of questions / tests / meetings — 一連串問題 / 測試 / 會議**

Practice 1

> The interviewer asked a **series of questions**.

面試官問了**一連串問題**。

Practice 2

> We held a **series of meetings** over several weeks.

我們在數星期內舉行了**一系列會議**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a series of X = 同類活動或事物在一段時間內多次接續出現

4. **series (作品系列) — 系列作品**

A major lexical branch.

Practice 1

> This novel is the first book in a fantasy **series**.

這本小說是一套奇幻**系列作品**的第一本。

Practice 2

> She has written a **series** of children's books.

她寫了一**系列兒童讀物**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****series = 多部彼此相關、屬於同一主題、角色或創作計劃的作品****

5. ****book series — 叢書；系列書籍****

Practice 1

> The novel belongs to a popular ****book series****.

這本小說屬於一套很受歡迎的****系列書籍****。

Practice 2

> The ****series**** contains seven books.

這個****系列****共有七本書。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****book series = 由多本相關書籍組成的出版系列****

6. ****TV series — 電視劇集；電視系列節目****

A very common media sense.

Practice 1

> We watched a new ****TV series**** last night.

我們昨晚看了一套新的****電視劇集****。

Practice 2

> The ****series**** has ten episodes.

這套****劇集****有十集。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****TV series = 由多集相關內容組成、通常持續播出的電視節目或劇集****

7. ****series vs episode — 系列 vs 一集****

Practice 1

> The **series** has twelve **episodes**.

這套**劇集**共有十二**集**。

Practice 2

> I watched the first episode of the **series**.

我看了這套**劇集**的第一集。

MCQ-ready definition:

series = 整套作品；episode = 系列中的其中一集

8. **lecture / concert / event series** — 講座 / 音樂會 / 活動系列

Practice 1

> The university organized a **lecture series** on history.

大學舉辦了一個歷史**講座系列**。

Practice 2

> The orchestra announced a summer **concert series**.

樂團宣布了一個夏季**音樂會系列**。

MCQ-ready definition:

X series = 多個有共同主題或安排的相關活動組成的一套系列

9. **series (運動賽事系列)** — 系列賽；一組賽事

Practice 1

> The two teams played a five-game **series**.

兩支球隊進行了一個五場的**系列賽**。

Practice 2

> They won the **series** three games to one.

他們以三比一贏得這個**系列賽**。

MCQ-ready definition:

series = 兩隊或多名參賽者之間由多場比賽組成的一組賽事

10. **World Series — 世界大賽**

A lexicalized proper-name use in baseball.

Practice 1

> The team reached the **World Series**.

球隊打入了**世界大賽**。

Practice 2

> He watched every game of the **World Series**.

他看了**世界大賽**的每一場比賽。

MCQ-ready definition:

World Series = 美國職棒大聯盟的年度冠軍系列賽

This is a fixed proper name, not simply any worldwide sporting series.

11. **series of numbers / values — 數列；一串數值**

Practice 1

> The code contains a **series of numbers**.

這組代碼包含**一串數字**。

Practice 2

> Students studied a **series of values**.

學生研究**一系列數值**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****series = 按某種次序排列的一串數字、數值或元素****

12. ****mathematical series — 級數****

A technical mathematical sense.

Practice 1

> The students learned about infinite ****series****.

學生學習了無窮****級數****。

Practice 2

> This ****series**** converges to a finite value.

這個****級數****收斂至一個有限值。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****series = 數學中由一系列數項相加所形成的表達或總和****

13. ****series circuit — 串聯電路****

A standard technical compound.

Practice 1

> The bulbs are connected in a ****series circuit****.

燈泡以****串聯電路****連接。

Practice 2

> In a ****series circuit****, current passes through each component in turn.

在****串聯電路****中，電流依次流經每個元件。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****series circuit = 電路元件沿同一路徑逐一串聯連接的電路****

14. ****in series** — 串聯地；依次連接******

Practice 1

> The batteries are connected ****in series****.

電池以****串聯方式****連接。

Practice 2

> The components were arranged ****in series****.

元件被****依次串聯****排列。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****in series** = 多個元件沿同一順序或路徑依次連接******

15. ****series** (產品型號 / 系列) — 系列；產品線******

Practice 1

> This laptop belongs to the company's new X ****Series****.

這部手提電腦屬於公司的新 X ****系列****。

Practice 2

> The manufacturer launched a new ****series**** of cameras.

製造商推出了一個新的相機****系列****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****series** = 同一品牌下設計、功能或定位相關的一組產品******

16. ****serial** (adjective : 連續的；系列性的) — 連續的；一連串的******

Practice 1

> The police investigated several ****serial offences****.

警方調查了多宗****連續發生的相關罪行****。

Practice 2

> The device uses **serial communication**.

該裝置使用**串行通訊**。

MCQ-ready definition:

serial = 按次序連續發生、排列或傳送的

17. **serial number — 序號；產品編號**

A very common compound.

Practice 1

> Enter the product's **serial number**.

輸入產品的**序號**。

Practice 2

> The **serial number** is printed on the back.

產品編號印在背面。

MCQ-ready definition:

serial number = 用來識別單一產品或物件的一組獨特編號

18. **serial killer / serial offender — 連環殺手 / 慣犯**

Practice 1

> The documentary was about a **serial killer**.

這套紀錄片講述一名**連環殺手**。

Practice 2

> The court described him as a **serial offender**.

法庭形容他是**多次重犯的慣犯**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****serial + person = 多次在不同時間重複進行同類行為的人，常用於犯罪語境****

19. ****serial (noun : 連載作品) — 連載故事 ; 連續劇****

Practice 1

> The story first appeared as a newspaper ****serial****.

這個故事最初以報章****連載小說****形式刊登。

Practice 2

> The radio ****serial**** became extremely popular.

那套廣播****連續劇****非常受歡迎。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****serial = 分成多個部分，按固定時間逐次發布的故事或節目****

20. ****serialize / serialise — 連載****

Practice 1

> The novel was ****serialized**** in a magazine.

這本小說曾在雜誌上****連載****。

Practice 2

> The newspaper ****serialised**** the story over several months.

報章用了幾個月時間****連載這個故事****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****serialize/serialise = 把故事或作品分成多個部分，逐次刊登或播放****

21. ****serialization / serialisation — 連載 ; 序列化****

Practice 1

> The novel's newspaper **serialization** increased its popularity.

小說在報章上的**連載**令它更受歡迎。

Practice 2

> The system uses data **serialization**.

這個系統使用資料**序列化**。

MCQ-ready definition:

serialization = 把內容分成連續部分發布；在電腦領域亦可指把資料轉換成可按序儲存或傳輸的形式

Important distinction 1: **series** vs **sequence**

series

emphasizes a group of related items/events.

sequence

emphasizes their order.

> a series of meetings

一系列會議

> the sequence of events

事件的先後次序

A series may have an order, but **sequence** focuses more strongly on that order.

Important distinction 2: **series** vs **list**

list

items written or presented one after another.

series

items are usually related by theme, occurrence, design, or continuity.

> a list of names

名字清單

> a series of events

一連串事件

Important distinction 3: **series vs group**

group

items/people considered together.

series

often suggests:

- * connection
- * order
- * repetition
- * progression through time

So a group does not necessarily form a series.

Important distinction 4: **series vs set**

set

collection regarded as a complete group.

series

often emphasizes related items appearing in succession.

> a set of tools

一套工具

> a series of lectures

一系列講座

There is overlap in products/books, but the conceptual emphasis differs.

Important distinction 5: **series** vs **collection**

collection

things gathered together.

series

things designed, occurring, or published as related units.

> an art collection

藝術收藏

> a TV series

電視劇集

Important distinction 6: **series** vs **episode**

series

whole programme.

episode

one instalment.

> I finished the series.

我看完整套劇。

> I watched one episode.

我看了一集。

Important distinction 7: **series** vs **season**

Especially important for TV.

series

the entire show, especially in AmE; in BrE **series** can sometimes also refer to one run/season.

season

one production/broadcast cycle containing several episodes.

> Season 2 of the series

這套劇的第二季

Learners should note the BrE/AmE variation.

Important distinction 8: **series** has the same singular and plural form

This is crucial.

Singular

> one **series**

一個系列

Plural

> three **series**

三個系列

Not:

> *three serieses* ❌

So **series** behaves like a noun whose written form does not change in the plural.

Important distinction 9: ****a series of + plural noun + singular/plural verb****

The head noun is ****series****, so formal agreement is often singular:

> A series of meetings ****was**** arranged.

安排了一系列會議。

But proximity and usage variation sometimes produce plural agreement in informal English.

For learner English, the safest standard pattern is:

****a series of X + singular verb****

Important distinction 10: ****series vs serial****

****series****

usually noun:

> a TV series

一套電視劇

****serial****

can be noun or adjective:

> a radio serial

> 廣播連續劇

> serial number

> 序號

They are related but not interchangeable.

Important distinction 11: ****TV series vs TV serial****

****TV series****

episodes may be linked by recurring characters/theme, but each can be partly self-contained.

TV serial

traditionally emphasizes an ongoing story continuing directly from episode to episode.

In modern everyday usage, **series** is far more common as the broad term.

Important distinction 12: **serial number does not mean “series number”

The standard expression is:

serial number

= unique identifying number

not usually:

series number

So this is a lexicalized compound.

Important distinction 13: **serial = repeated vs series = group

serial offender

person repeatedly committing similar offences.

series of offences

the offences themselves form the sequence/group.

So:

* **serial** modifies the repeating actor/pattern

* **series** names the collection

Important distinction 14: **series circuit vs parallel circuit

**series circuit

one path; components connected one after another.

parallel circuit

multiple branches/paths.

This is a genuine technical use of the sequential core.

Important distinction 15: **mathematical sequence vs series**

In mathematics:

sequence

an ordered list of terms.

series

the sum of the terms in a sequence.

So they must not be treated as exact synonyms in mathematics.

Family-extension note

Series has a remarkably coherent core:

multiple related units occurring, appearing, or being arranged in succession

From this, English develops several major branches:

1. **successive events/things**

- * a series of stories
- * a series of questions

2. **creative works**

- * TV series
- * book series

3. **organized activities**

- * lecture series
- * concert series

4. **sports**

- * game series
- * World Series

5. **numbers / mathematics**

- * series of numbers
- * mathematical series

6. **technical arrangement**

- * series circuit
- * in series

7. **product families**

- * camera series
- * X Series

8. **serial family**

- * serial number
- * serial offender
- * serial
- * serialize

The meanings remain closely connected by the notion of **successive related units**, so we should avoid artificially splitting every collocation into a separate bare-word sense.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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a series of stories	一連串故事	successive related items	
series of events	一連串事件	connected occurrences	
series of questions	一連串問題	successive items	
book series	系列書籍	connected works	
TV series	電視劇集 / 系列節目	episodic programme	
lecture series	系列講座	related events	
concert series	系列音樂會	related performances	

sports series	系列賽	multiple games	
World Series	世界大賽	fixed baseball title	
series of numbers	一串數字	ordered items	
mathematical series	級數	sum of sequence terms	
series circuit	串聯電路	sequential connection	
in series	串聯	connected one after another	
product series	產品系列	related product line	
serial	連續的；系列的	occurring successively	
serial number	序號	unique identifier	
serial killer	連環殺手	repeated offences	
serial (noun)	連載作品	published in instalments	
serialize	連載；序列化	arrange/release sequentially	
serialization	連載；序列化	process of serializing	

For your original sentence

> Instead, he made it feel like a ****series of human stories****.

Here:

****series = 一連串；一系列彼此相關的事物****

The important idea is not just that there were ****many stories****. ****Series**** suggests that the stories connected and unfolded one after another, helping students see history as human experience rather than isolated facts.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 相反地，他把歷史講得像****一連串關於人的故事****。

For this passage, ****「一連串」**** is particularly good because it captures the sense of historical events and human stories unfolding through time.